

Tesfaye Fenta Boka

PhD Candidate in Computer Science
Beijing Institute of Technology, Beijing, China
tfenta@bit.edu.cn | +86 151-1693-2735

Research Interests

Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Data Mining, Sequential Recommendation Systems, Cross-Domain Recommendation, Large Language Models

Education

Ph.D. in Computer Science Sept 2022 – June 2026 (Expected)
Beijing Institute of Technology, Beijing, China

Supervisor: Prof. Zhendong Niu

Research Focus: Sequential Recommendation Systems, Cross-Domain Recommendations, Large Language Models

M.Sc. in Computer Science Aug 2020
Ambo University, Oromia, Ethiopia CGPA: 4.00/4.00

B.Sc. in Computer Science July 2015
Ambo University, Oromia, Ethiopia CGPA: 3.37/4.00

Publications

Journal Articles

- [1] **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**, Zhendong Niu, Tekie Tsegay Tewolde, Ramadhani A. Duma. Domain-aware Self-prompting for Cross-domain Sequential Recommendations with Natural Language Explanations. *Neural Networks*, 2025. (Elsevier, IF: 6.3)
- [2] **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**, Zhendong Niu. BiTrans-CDSR: Bidirectional Knowledge Transfer for Cross-Domain Sequential Recommendation via Joint User-Item Overlap Modeling. *Knowledge-Based Systems*, 2026. (Elsevier, IF: 7.6, Accepted)
- [3] **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**, Zhendong Niu, Rama Bastola Neupane. A Survey of Sequential Recommendation Systems: Techniques, Evaluation, and Future Directions. *Information Systems*, vol. 125, pp. 102427, 2024. (Elsevier, IF: 3.4)
- [4] Rama Bastola Neupane, Kan Li, **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**. A Survey on Deep 3D Human Pose Estimation. *Artificial Intelligence Review*, vol. 58, no. 1, pp. 24, 2024. (Springer, IF: 13.9)
- [5] **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**, Kabada Sori Ayana, Karthikeyan Kaliyaperumal, Megersa Oljira Rase, Bayisa Natea Sima. Leukemia Ontology-Based Decision Supporting System for Diagnosis and Treatment. *Design Engineering*, 2021.
- [6] Amit Pandey, Rajesh Kumar, Kedir Assefa Senbato, Genale Asedo, Shektofik Ahmed, **Tesfaye Fenta**. Model for Predicting Survivability of Soft Tissue Sarcoma Using Stacking Classifier. *Annals of R.S.C.B.*, 2021.
- [7] Rajesh Kumar, Amit Pandey, Asedo Shektofik Ahmed, **Tesfaye Fenta**, Assefa Senbato Genale, Biniyam Alemu. The Role of 5G Technology Combating COVID-19 Pandemic. *Annals of R.S.C.B.*, 2021.

Under Review

- [8] **Tesfaye Fenta Boka**, et al. User-Adaptive LLM Prompt Template Engineering for Enhancing Cross-Domain Sequential Recommendation. *User Modeling and User-Adapted Interaction*. (Major Revision)

Professional Experience

Lecturer

Aug 2020 – Dec 2022

Bule Hora University, Oromia, Ethiopia

- Teaching undergraduate and graduate courses in Computer Science
- Conducting research in machine learning and data science
- Supervising student projects and theses

Department Head

Feb 2021 – Nov 2022

Computer Science and Engineering Department, Bule Hora University

- Led department strategic planning and curriculum development
- Managed faculty and academic programs for 15+ faculty members
- Coordinated research initiatives and industry collaborations

Emerging Technology Course Coordinator

Dec 2020 – Feb 2021

Bule Hora University, Oromia, Ethiopia

- Designed and implemented emerging technology curriculum
- Coordinated with industry partners for practical training programs

Assistant Lecturer

Feb 2017 – July 2020

Bule Hora University, Oromia, Ethiopia

- Taught computer science courses to undergraduate students
- Assisted in research projects and student supervision

Graduate Assistant

Feb 2016 – Feb 2017

Bule Hora University, Oromia, Ethiopia

- Supported faculty in teaching and research activities
- Assisted with laboratory sessions and student guidance

Technical Skills

Programming:	Python, Java, C++, C#
ML/DL Frameworks:	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, Hugging Face Transformers
Data Science:	Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Data Visualization
Tools & Platforms:	Git, LaTeX, Linux, Jupyter Notebook, Google Colab
Research Areas:	Recommendation Systems, NLP, Deep Learning, Data Mining, LLMs

Awards and Honors

Certificate of Outstanding Performance

2021

Ranked second among college teachers in effective teaching, research, community services, and leadership engagements at Bule Hora University

Professional Development and Training

- **Tsinghua University Innovation & Entrepreneurship Program** for Digital Economy (Sept 2023)
- **Beijing Institute of Technology Knowing China – Intelligence Makes Future Program** (Aug 2023)
- **International Conference on Data Science and Data Analytics** (Sept 2023)
- **Harmony OS Development Certificate**, Huawei (Aug 2023)
- **Data Analysis and Fundamentals Certificate** (Aug 2024)
- **Grant Proposal Development and Management Training** (Jan 2020)
- **Research Paper Preparation using LaTeX** (Apr 2019)

Certifications

- IELTS Academic (Sept 2024)
- HSK Level 3 – Chinese Proficiency (July 2023)
- IoT, Wireless, and Cloud Computing Emerging Technologies (Nov 2020)
- Introduction to HTML5 (Nov 2020)
- Usable Security (Nov 2020)
- Understanding Research Methods (Nov 2020)

Languages

English:	Fluent (Listening, Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Oromo:	Native
Amharic:	Fluent
Chinese (Mandarin):	Intermediate (HSK 3 – Listening and Reading)

Last updated: January 2026